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Preface

This book contains the short and work-in-progress contributions of the 40th International and Interdisciplinary Conference on Environmental Informatics – EnviroInfo 2026.

Held from 9 to 11 September 2026 at the University of Łódź, Poland, the conference was organized by the technical committee of Environmental Informatics of the Gesellschaft für Informatik e.V. (GI). It took place in conjunction with the international scientific conference "Sustainable Development and Other Paradigms and Concepts in the Context of Contemporary Civilization Trends – Global and Local Dimensions" (SD26) and the Annual Meeting of the Polish Association of Environmental Economists.

Over four decades, the EnviroInfo series has brought together researchers and practitioners from across the world who work at the intersection of applied computer science and environmental sustainability. The shared ambition has always been to translate advances in information and communication technologies into concrete steps toward a more sustainable society.

The theme of EnviroInfo 2026 – "Sustainable Development and Other Paradigms and Concepts in the Context of Contemporary Civilization Trends – Global and Local Dimensions" – opens up the conversation beyond any single framework. It situates environmental informatics within a wider debate about how societies, at both local and global scales, respond to the pressures of our time: through green computing and sustainable software, through circular economy models, through business intelligence, and through the critical examination of the paradigms that shape development itself.

The contributions gathered here are works in progress or early-stage results – deliberately so. This volume is a space for approaches that are still taking shape, for questions not yet fully answered, and for methodological experiments that connect disciplines and cross the boundary between research and practice. Taken together, they map a field in motion: from data infrastructures and environmental management systems to green coding, sustainability indicators, and the interfaces between science, policy, and civil society.

We thank all authors for sharing their work at this stage of development. We equally thank the members of the program and organization committee for their thorough and careful reviews. We thank the University of Łódź as host, the organizers of SD26 and the Polish Association of Environmental Economists as co-organizers, and the Gesellschaft für Informatik e.V. We also thank the European universities of the UNIC alliance (European University of Cities in Post-industrial Transition – UNIC 2.0), for their cooperation in making this conference possible.

Finally, we thank our sponsors, whose support was essential to making this conference happen.

Łódź, September 2026

On behalf of the Organizing Committee

Volker Wohlgemuth, Stefan Naumann, Grit Behrens, Malgorzata Burchard-Dziubińska

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